

ALISA UTESHEVA

PRODUCT DESIGNER · UX / UI

alisaux.com • linkedin.com/in/alisaux • alisamuux@gmail.com • 510.480.0142

Product designer grounded in user research — the decisions below trace back to an interview, a survey number, or something a tester said. Comfortable across the full process: research, wireframes, interaction design, and high-fidelity prototyping in Figma.

KEY SKILLS

Design & Prototyping: Figma, FigJam, Framer, Webflow

Visual & Motion: Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Procreate, After Effects, Premiere Pro

Development: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Git / GitHub

Research & Process: User Interviews, Usability Testing, Preference Testing, Competitive Analysis, Persona Development, User Flows, Information Architecture, Wireframing, Design Systems, Responsive Design, Accessibility / WCAG

AI: ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Midjourney, Adobe Firefly, Kling AI

Interpersonal: Collaboration, Storytelling, User Advocacy, Clear Communication, Giving & Receiving Feedback, Conflict Resolution

RECENT ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Reboot · *Visual Discovery App for Gamers*

- Designed a Pinterest-style discovery app for gamers, built around a board and sub-board system for organizing builds, guides, and inspiration in one place.
- Ran a focus group in which 3 of 3 participants couldn't find the Explore feature and asked for clearer, step-by-step guidance. Redesigned the primary navigation and added in-app walkthroughs to fix it.
- Preference-tested two icon options for a drag interaction: testers read a hamburger icon as "grab" immediately, while an arrow icon confused people. Went with the hamburger.
- Built and tested high-fidelity Figma prototypes across three core user flows: Explore, Boards, and Guided Walkthroughs.

Spotify Redesign · *Personalized Home Screen*

- Redesigned Spotify's home screen so users can hide, reorder, and customize sections based on how they actually listen.
- Two rounds of usability testing: 2 of 3 testers found an arrow icon confusing for dragging, so I switched to a hamburger icon. All 3 testers expected light mode inside Settings, not a separate icon, so I moved it there.
- Interviewed users with different listening habits, a commuter, a product manager, a barista, and built personas that actually reflected how differently they used the app.
- Delivered a working Figma prototype of the full personalization flow.

Nuance · *Personalized Beauty & Shade-Matching App*

- Surveyed 14 respondents and usability-tested with 7 more across two rounds, 21 participants in all, to build a grounded user persona. 85.7% had been disappointed by an online beauty recommendation before, and 57.1% said they trusted sponsored reviews less.
- Designed a shade-matching quiz and a routine-compatibility checker to solve the biggest trust problem the research uncovered.
- Built and usability-tested high-fidelity Figma prototypes across three flows: Discover, Match, and Routine.

MindScoop · *CBS KPIX SF Collaborative Project*

- UX Designer on a three-person team that pitched on site at CBS and was recognized as a Breakthrough Insight. Owned the Pop Quiz app integration and the MindScoop TikTok prototype alongside concept development and the interactive set experience.

EDUCATION & ACTIVITIES

BFA in Interaction and UX/UI Design · **Academy of Art University, 3.7 GPA (May 2026)**

Coursework: Web Design, User Experience, Visual Design, Motion Graphics, Typography, Design Technology, Design Thinking, Visual Communication, Visual Storytelling & Editing.

Udemy Certifications: Figma, Figma Advanced, Photoshop, Illustrator